VIDEO · AI AGENTS · TESTING

AI agent testing for business analysts

Your agent passed the demo. Will it pass production? Three gates: dev, UAT and prod.

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WHY IT MATTERS

Ask it twice, get two answers.

Every testing habit we have assumes the same input gives the same output. An AI agent doesn't promise that. Gartner expects over 40% of agentic AI projects to be canceled by the end of 2027, partly over weak risk controls.

GATE 1 · DEV

Is it good enough?

GATE 2 · UAT

Is it good enough for us?

GATE 3 · PROD

Is it still good enough on a Tuesday?

Source: Gartner press release, 25 June 2025

GATE 1 · DEV

Build a golden set.
Write the pass mark first.

Real cases with the right answer written next to each one. Not demo questions.
Then split them into buckets, because mistakes don't cost the same.

EASY

98%

The refund that's obviously fine.

MESSY

90%

Every miss goes to a person, not out the door.

MUST-NEVER

100%

Already refunded. Bigger than the payment.

Example: Northstar Systems (a made-up client), an agent that reads refund emails and decides approve, reject or hand to a person.

GATE 1 · DEV

Run the golden set three times.

Same cases, same agent. If an answer flips between runs, the case is unstable, and unstable is a finding.

```
Case 47
run 1: approve
run 2: approve
run 3: reject
```

LOG IT LIKE A DEFECT

Not a 2-out-of-3 pass. An unstable case, with an owner.

An AI agent doesn't pass a test. It passes a pass rate.

GATE 2 · UAT

The weird cases, the handoffs, one page.

- Ask the people who handle refunds today: what's the weirdest email you got this year?
- Test the handoff: when the agent isn't sure, does it pass the case to a person with the context attached?
- Sign off on one page: pass rate per bucket against the bar you set first, every must-never result, every miss with an owner
- Must-never under 100% means no-go. Not "we'll fix it in hypercare."

GATE 3 · PROD

Your requirements sit still. The world moves.

The vendor updates the model, customers write differently, a new product brings new questions. Same code, different behavior.

RERUN

The golden set becomes the regression test for every model or prompt change.

SAMPLE WEEKLY

A person scores 50 real cases: overrule rate, escalation rate, cost per case.

OFF SWITCH

One must-never mistake and the agent stops acting until a named owner signs it back on.

BONUS TRICK

AI writes the hard questions. Humans write the right answers.

Give a model ten real emails and ask for twenty nasty variations: typos, two requests in one email, furious, overly polite, the wrong order number. A person writes the right answer for each one before it goes in the golden set.

FREE TEMPLATE

The AI agent test plan with buckets, pass marks, the three-run check and the one-page scorecard: `github.com/prachitparikh/ba-toolkit`

WATCH THE FULL WALKTHROUGH

youtube.com/watch?v=lBteCgiXc6Q

8 minutes, animated, with a six-question quiz at the end. Dev, UAT and prod, step by step.

Prachit Parikh · Business analyst. I turn what stakeholders ask for into requirements a team can test, check the data with SQL, and see changes through UAT.

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